Running stitch join step card

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 1 Week 5 Thursday 4 February 2027 P1 Year A

Use this default method only when it matches the actual approved design. An adult demonstrates and supervises needle and scissor use. Use prepared pieces or adult handling if needed.

1 Align and mark

Put the two cut pieces together with edges aligned. Follow the 10 mm seam guide on the left, bottom and right. Keep the top open. Hold the layers together using only the adult’s approved method.

2 Thread and start

The adult selects a suitable needle and thread for the actual fabric. The adult shows passing thread through the needle eye and tying a small tail knot, or provides a prepared threaded needle. Start between layers and bring the needle out through the upper layer at the guide so the knot stays inside. Do not force an unsuitable needle through dense fabric.

3 Pass through both layers

Move about 5 mm along the line and put the needle through both layers. Keep fingers clear of where it will come out. Bring it back through both layers about 5 mm further along. Pull the thread gently away from faces until it lies flat. Keep the fabric flat rather than gathered.

4 Repeat along three sides

Repeat small even passes about 5 mm apart. Pause to check that both layers are joined and the edges still align. Turn the work at a corner while the needle is safe. Join the left, bottom and right only. The top stays open.

Secure the join and record it

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5 Secure the end

The adult demonstrates on the back: take a small stitch through both layers, leaving a loop before pulling tight. Pass the needle through the loop and pull it snug. Repeat once. Trim the thread only using agreed scissors. Keep a short secure tail and avoid cutting the seam.

Return tools and check

Count and return every needle. Check both layers are joined, the thread lies flat, the three edges hold together and the top is open. Do not rush to finish when time runs out. Store unfinished work safely for Week 6.

If a bond was chosen

Use an adhesive route only if it is in the actual approved design and the adult has checked the fabric, product label, ventilation and access needs. Follow that label for application and full cure time. Do not invent a curing time or test an uncured join. No heat or solvents are used. Keep joining or testing pending where needed.

Safe alternatives

An adult can handle the needle while the pupil directs each action. Keep that role clear in the record. A prepared demonstration sample may support explanation but is not the pupil’s own completed join.

Materials free rehearsal

With no fabric or safe tools, use a paper model or empty-hand rehearsal. Mark imagined measurements, explain the cut line and trace the running stitch route. Record this as planning or simulation. Keep textile measuring, cutting and joining evidence pending until those actions happen on actual fabric with approved tools.